

Narrative Writing - The Hidden Message

English - Year 5 | Narrative Writing | ACARA v9.0: AC9E5LY06

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0: AC9E5LY06 - plan, create and edit written texts for imaginative, informative and persuasive purposes.

Learning Intention

I can plan and write an imaginative narrative with a clear setting, character, complication and resolution.

Writing Strategy

Build suspense through sensory detail, careful pacing, dialogue and clues that make the reader want to continue.

Writing Topic: A student finds a mysterious note tucked inside an old library book. Write a narrative that builds suspense and reveals what the note means.

Vocabulary Helper

suspense	a feeling of excitement or worry about what might happen
clue	a detail that helps solve a mystery
resolution	the ending where the problem is solved

A. Plan Your Writing

Setting Where and when does the mystery begin?	
Character Who finds the hidden message?	
Complication What problem or mystery appears?	
Resolution How will the mystery be solved?	

Narrative Mystery Writing Toolkit

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Sentence Starters

- The room felt unusually silent when...
- At first, I thought it was ordinary, but...
- A small detail made me stop and look again...
- The message seemed to warn me that...

Mini Model / Success Guide

Ava paused beside the dusty library shelf. A folded note slipped from the pages like a secret escaping. The words were faded, but one sentence was clear: Do not open the blue door after sunset.

A. Warm Up

List three details that could make a place feel mysterious.

B. Build Your Skills

Write a short scene where a character discovers a clue. Include one sensory detail and one line of dialogue.

C. Strong Challenge

Add a twist. How could the clue mean something different from what the character first thinks?

Draft Your Narrative Mystery

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Write a complete draft. Use your plan, clear paragraphs, precise vocabulary and correct punctuation. Leave time to reread and improve one sentence.

Title: _____

Edit, Check and Reflect

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Student Checklist - Tick What You Included

☐ I introduced a clear setting and character.	☐ I included a complication or mystery.
☐ I used sensory details to build mood.	☐ I included dialogue or inner thoughts.
☐ I revealed clues in a logical order.	☐ I wrote a resolution that fits the story.
☐ I checked punctuation in dialogue.	☐ I improved at least one sentence.

Quick Self-Assessment

My strongest sentence was:	
One thing I improved during editing was:	

Parent Tip

Ask your child to tell the story problem aloud before writing. A clear problem makes the draft easier to organise.

Teacher Tip

Model one suspense sentence on the board, then ask students which word choices create tension.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____
Next step: _____